

Finals Essay Task 1.

Assessment on your Understanding as to what really matters to become Data Analysts.

And How to integrate SQL into your Data Analysis

Instruction:

Read the attached Article and video link before answering the questions.

Video link: <https://youtu.be/hGCKdMsU7g>

Article Link:

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1FhanZgD5YFiBJP0088UbEWaN7DEFbgiE/view?usp=s>
haring

Following the video that you have watch and article that I ask you to read please answer the ff: question using your own words in 2–3 sentences based on the provided source material.

1. What are the four primary factors that will differentiate a data analyst candidate in 2026?
 - *Candidates will stand out if they have strong business knowledge, can explain their findings clearly, have real project experience, and use a small set of tools very well. Employers want analysts who can solve actual problems, not just write code. Showing real impact and explaining things clearly is more important than knowing lots of tools.*
2. How does domain knowledge provide a competitive advantage over purely technical candidates?
 - *Domain knowledge helps analysts understand what the data actually means and what problems need solving. This allows them to ask better questions and produce insights that are useful for the business. Purely technical candidates may process data well but often lack context for decision-making.*
3. What is the "lean tech stack" recommended for a foundational data analyst role?
 - *The lean tech stack focuses on essential tools like SQL, spreadsheets, and a visualization tool such as Power BI or Tableau. These tools are enough to clean, analyze, and present data effectively. It emphasizes depth over learning too many technologies.*

4. Distinguish between "learning projects" and "showing projects."

- *Learning projects are built to practice skills and understand concepts, often following tutorials. Showing projects are designed to demonstrate real-world problem-solving and are meant for portfolios or job applications. The latter focuses on business impact and storytelling.*

5. According to the roadmap, why is Python often deprioritized for mid-career data analyst positions?

- *Python is often less critical because many analyst tasks can already be handled efficiently with SQL and BI tools. Mid-career roles prioritize business insights and communication over heavy programming. Python becomes more relevant in advanced or specialized roles like data science.*

Questions on SQL-Base on the Article Posted

6. Why is establishing the "Business Context" essential for an analyst? What is a Business Context?

- *Business context means understanding what the data represents, what problem it solves, and who will use the results . It is essential because analysis without context can lead to meaningless or misleading insights. It guides the analyst in asking the right questions.*

7. According to the text, how does SQL function as a "flashlight"?

- *SQL is described as a flashlight because it helps you explore and uncover what is inside the data . It allows analysts to inspect patterns, errors, and hidden issues step by step. It's a tool for discovery, not just querying.*

8. Why is the validation step considered a professional necessity rather than an optional task?

- *Validation ensures the data is accurate and free from errors before analysis begins . Skipping this step can lead to incorrect conclusions and loss of credibility. Professionals prioritize it to produce reliable insights.*

9. What defines "good SQL" according to the author's standards?

- *Good SQL is simple, readable, and easy to explain . It should clearly answer a business question without unnecessary complexity. Clarity and trust are more important than writing long queries.*

10. Describe the fundamental mindset shift required to move from being a student to being an analyst.

- *The shift is from focusing on writing correct queries to focusing on solving real-world problems using data. Instead of just completing tasks, an analyst thinks about what the data means and how it can support decisions. It's about being curious, asking the right questions, and turning data into useful insights.*